

MINNEAPOLIS SUNDAY TRIBUNE

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April 22, 1956

Mike Kelley Heads Millers' Honor Roll

Mike Kelley, who had been at St. Paul, came into the Miller picture in 1924 with the Thirty Owners. Backed by two millionaire friends, Mike shortly purchased complete control from George Belden and his pals.

It took a few years to get going, but Mike was encouraged when, in 1928, the Millers lost the pennant to Indianapolis only when Wid Mathews, now Cub farm system boss, hit a fly ball on the fair territory triangle atop Nicolet's roof.

IN 1932, Kelley made Donie Bush field manager and new glories were born. Donie won in 1932, went to Cincinnati while Dave Bancroft finished second in 1933, then came back to win in 1934 and 35. Joe Hauser hit his 69 home runs in 1933 — and it was the year before that — 1932 — that saw the Game of the Six Decisions.

The Millers, leading Newark two games to one in the Little World Series, came to Minneapolis to finish it up.

With a Newark runner on second, a short fly was hit to left center. Middle gardener Harry Rice tore in, dove for the ball and seemingly made the catch.

THE SECOND BASE umpire ruled the hitter out. The third base umpire ruled Rice had not caught the ball. The deci-



MIKE KELLEY

sion was changed FIVE times before it finally was decided Rice had dropped the ball, with a big run crossing the plate. Newark took the game and later the series.

This was a "clutch" Miller array for a stretch — Hauser, Andy Cohen, Ernie Smith and Leo Norris and Babe Ganzel were the infield, with Rosy Ryan, Jess Petty and Rube Benton spearheading the mound corps. Joe Mowry, Spence Harris, Art Ruble, Wes Griffin, Paul Richards (yes, the Oriole manager), Johnny Gill and Fabe Gaffke were some of the others.

RED KRESS, Carl Reynolds and Dusty Cooke came in 1937, a year which also marked the appearance of night baseball — against Mike Kelley's wishes.

Ted Williams was the big hero in 1938, just a big kid out of California. In 1940 it was Ab Wright, who hit four homers and a triple in a single game. That's a record of 19 total bases that still stands.

FLORIDA POPULAR

Twelve major league teams and 35 minor league clubs trained in Florida this year.